

Belgium

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

1 Starting point

Population	11.88 m
GDP	EUR 642 bn
Public administration (NACE O)	447 k
Electricity price	186.6 EUR/MWh
Renewables	31.3%
Live hyperscaler regions	2

2 What is structurally different

- No structural flags differ from the Dutch reference case; the Dutch design rules transfer directly.

3 Capacity

Servers	3,527 (CPU 2,430 / GPU 167 / storage 930)
IT critical load	5.8 MW
Facility design load	8.7 MW
Sites	3 (by capacity 1, floor 3)
Average per site	2.9 MW
Site count set by	the minimum-sites floor, not capacity
CAPEX	EUR 207 m
OPEX	EUR 21 m / yr

4 Proposed geography

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Brussels - Flemish Brabant	Primary civil cloud	41%	3.5	Federal institutions, BNIX, Smals/G-Cloud estate; Elia connection queue is the constraint.
Wallonia / Mons - Charleroi	Sovereign secondary	27%	2.4	Existing hyperscale cluster (St. Ghislain) proves power and fibre; south of Meuse flood zone.
Antwerp - Limburg	Government / continuity	23%	2.0	Northern separation, port/industrial grid.
Liege - Ardennes	Strategic reserve	10%	0.9	Eastern reserve; avoid 2021 Vesdre/Ourthe flood plains.

First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.

5 Legal and regulatory posture

Governing instrument	Federal cloud policy via FPS BOSA; Smals framework rules on sovereignty and portability (2026)
Cloud certification	No national scheme; ISO 27001 plus EU cloud code of conduct
Data classification	Classification Act 1998: Vertrouwelijk / Geheim / Zeer Geheim
Procurement route	FPS BOSA federal framework; Smals for social-security IT

Foreign jurisdiction exposure. Google Cloud selected as federal public-cloud pillar (Jun 2026); Microsoft 365 already broadly deployed

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

6 Current state and provider landscape

Government cloud	Federal G-Cloud (BOSA/Smals community cloud); Smals selected Google Cloud as public-cloud pillar (Jun 2026) under federal sovereignty/portability rules
Maturity	operational
Digital identity	Belgian eID card + itsme (CSAM)
Interconnection	BNIX Brussels; transit via Amsterdam/London

7 Migration path and cost

Phase	Scope	MW	CAPEX	Cumulative	Hybrid
1	Sovereign core	2.1	EUR 41 m	20%	no
2	Security and defense	2.7	EUR 66 m	51%	no
3	State record	1.5	EUR 38 m	70%	no
4	Elective	2.4	EUR 63 m	100%	yes

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 41 m** for 2.1 MW, 20% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

8 Geography and threat notes

No seismic; dense and land-constrained; Meuse flood risk (2021); Elia grid connection queues around Brussels/Antwerp; nuclear extension to 2035; gas/electricity import dependent; NATO/EU HQ host (hybrid/cyber target)